

Luca Matei

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Summary

Self-taught engineer with 15+ years of programming experience. I started out building open-source frameworks, developer tools, and educational resources before moving into professional work.

Over the past 6 years, I've worked as an independent contractor for startups across Europe and the US — most recently as the sole engineer at a VC-backed travel startup that was acquired in 2026, and as a Senior AI Engineer at a healthcare AI company. Based in Romania, working remotely.

Tech Stack

Python, FastAPI, TypeScript, Next.js, PostgreSQL, Redis, AWS, Linux

Experience

Founding Engineer

Press On Ventures
May 2025 - Present
Remote, Contract
New York, United States

LLMs, TypeScript,
Next.js, PostgreSQL,
Redis

[citanatravel.com](#)
[Product Hunt](#)

Sole engineer at Citana Travel, a VC-backed AI travel startup where I built the entire technical product from scratch. Acquired in 2026 by a strategic buyer in the luxury travel industry

- Owned the entire technical build as the sole engineer — B2C booking platform, B2B admin dashboard, and multi-agent AI backend
- Worked closely with the product lead to translate vision into a shipped product, handling all engineering from first commit to acquisition
- Built end-to-end: authentication, payments, LLM orchestration, observability, and production infrastructure
- Startup was acquired in 2026 by a strategic buyer in the luxury travel space

Senior AI Engineer

Optura AI
May 2025 - Jul 2025 · 3mo
Remote, Contract
Cluj, Romania

Terraform, Svelte, AWS,
LangGraph, TypeScript

[optura.ai](#)

Senior AI engineer at a healthcare AI startup, building an orchestration platform for enterprise data management and HIPAA-compliant automation

- Designed ETL pipelines for ingesting and structuring unstructured healthcare data at scale
- Implemented LLM guardrails for PII redaction and HIPAA regulatory compliance
- Delivered full-stack platform features across a Svelte frontend and AWS-backed infrastructure

Senior Full Stack Engineer

getitAI, Inc.

Oct 2023 - May 2025 · 1y 8mo

Remote, Contract

San Francisco, United States

Python, FastAPI,
TypeScript, Next.js,
PostgreSQL, Redis,
Shopify, AWS,
Clickhouse

getit.ai

Early engineer at an AI-powered e-commerce insights platform. Became the go-to engineer across the stack — owning full-stack dev, infrastructure, and Shopify integrations. Acquired by Private Equity in 2025

- Built multi-modal RAG system with Redis Stack vector search, cutting query latency from 300ms to under 12ms
- Architected multi-tenant Shopify integration syncing 6,000+ products and processing 150,000+ daily transactions in real time
- Owned infrastructure and DevOps — CI/CD pipelines, production deployments, feature rollout system with geographic segmentation
- Shipped LLM-powered tools for cart management, subscription processing, and agentic product knowledge retrieval
- Occasionally collaborated cross-functionally with RevOps, led standups, and coordinated the engineering team

Python Developer with DevOps

Signed NDA

Jul 2023 - Apr 2024 · 10mo

Remote, Contract

The Netherlands

Python, FastAPI,
PostgreSQL, Redis,
Linux, HAProxy, Docker

Contract role building and operating backend infrastructure for a SaaS API product

- Architected distributed multi-server system for high-volume request processing with HAProxy load balancing
- Refactored the core API for better performance and reliability, and implemented a usage-based credit system with subscription billing
- Owned the full infrastructure — self-hosted CI/CD, database clusters, VPS security hardening, and maintained 99.9% uptime

Projects

Available on lucamatei.eu/services.

#PayWhatYouWant

Personalized software consultancy offering technical guidance for projects, career development, and startup strategy. Operates on a value-based pricing model where clients determine compensation based on session impact and delivered value.

OSRAM Products Redis RAG

AI-powered search tool that lets users query OSRAM product specification documents in natural language. Built on a Redis vector database with hybrid semantic and keyword search for fast, accurate retrieval across technical PDFs.

Digital Marmot / Dima

Built before LLM-assisted programming and modern IaC tools like Ansible.

Full-stack infrastructure automation platform I built from scratch to manage my entire homelab — VM provisioning, networking, web app deployment,

and server hardening. Exposes 65+ commands via CLI and GUI, driven by a custom templating engine across multi-environment deployments. Also includes a custom WSGI web framework with multilingual CMS and an SCSS design system.

Education

Self-taught programming for 15 years.

Certifications

Certified Scrum Master through Scrum Alliance
Accountant through APSAP (Romania)

High School

Colegiul Național "Mihai Viteazul" București
Mathematics and Computer Science